

Aztec and Maya civilizations

Mesoamerica (meaning “middle America”) was home to the Maya. They lived in many cities ruled by kings who fought each other. Their civilization was at its height between 300 and 900 CE. Later, in the 16th century, the Aztecs of Mexico conquered a great empire. Both peoples built cities with tall, pyramid-shaped temples.



Carved Maya writing

Writing

The Maya were the only American people to invent a complete writing system, with signs standing for sounds and ideas. Maya writing was carved onto monuments and written in books made of fig tree bark.

